From:	Sarkis Daglian
To:	ostp-ai-rfi
Cc:	Henry L Jenkins; Kian Colestock; Thomas Andriola
Subject:	[External] AI Action Plan
Date:	Friday, March 14, 2025 7:35:31 PM

ATTN: Faisal D’Souza

Good Afternoon,

On behalf of the University of California, Irvine, I am submitting our comments and insights regarding the development of a comprehensive artificial intelligence action plan. We appreciate the opportunity afforded by the Trump administration to contribute to the dialogue on this vital innovation and growth sector, and we look forward to collaborating on strategies that ensure America remains at the forefront of AI research and development.

We have identified several strategic priorities that we believe are essential for sustaining the United States’ long-term leadership position in artificial intelligence innovation:

AI Research & Innovation Funding

- Expand federal AI grant funding to accelerate industry disruption and startup growth
    - Increase NSF, DOE, and DARPA AI research grants to fund breakthrough AI innovations that drive new business creation and industrial transformation.
    - Prioritize funding for applied AI research in healthcare, manufacturing, energy, and automation to accelerate commercialization.
- Authorize federal AI infrastructure funds for on-premises and cloud-based AI compute leasing
    - Modify NSF and DOE funding rules to allow universities, startups, and research labs to lease AI compute power from private cloud providers (AWS, Google Cloud, Microsoft Azure).
    - Establish a national AI compute marketplace, where institutions can access subsidized cloud-based GPUs and TPUs to reduce entry barriers for AI research.
    - Provide grant program funding for universities to acquire, deploy, and maintain on-premises GPUs and other necessary hardware capable of locally hosting LLMs and AIs for research purposes
- Develop regional AI supercomputing hubs for universities and industry collaboration
    - Provide federal matching funds to create regional AI high-performance computing (HPC) centers that serve multiple universities, research institutions, and AI startups.
    - Ensure these hubs have direct partnerships with private cloud and semiconductor

firms to offer state-of-the-art AI infrastructure.

- Expand private AI R&D partnerships through industry-funded university research labs
    - Offer federal R&D tax credits to corporations funding university-led AI research, allowing them to retain some commercial rights to resulting IP.
    - Encourage the creation of university AI innovation districts, where academia and industry collaborate without unnecessary regulatory barriers.

AI Education & Workforce Development

- Mandate AI education in K-12 and higher education curricula
    - Require AI literacy programs in K-12 education, focusing on prompt engineering, ethical use, and applications for research and knowledge acquisition.
    - Fund university AI degree programs and certification tracks that emphasize AI ethics, engineering, and security to build a competitive AI workforce.
- Expand corporate-sponsored AI research clusters in universities
    - Create federal tax incentives for corporations that sponsor high-performance AI research labs within universities.
    - Establish AI professorship endowments, where private-sector sponsorships fund faculty chairs specializing in AI model development and application.
- Incentivize AI adoption in university administration to reduce costs and increase efficiency
    - Provide federal performance-based grants to universities that implement AI-driven administrative automation, cutting waste in student services, budgeting, and HR operations.
    - Encourage public-private AI partnerships to develop cost-effective AI tools for higher education management.

AI Model Transparency, Explainability, and Open-Source Development

- Establish AI explainability and transparency standards for high-impact sectors
    - Require financial, healthcare, and government AI systems to meet baseline interpretability benchmarks, ensuring clear documentation and decision-making transparency.
    - Create a self-regulated AI assurance program, where companies can opt into third-party model audits without government-imposed restrictions.
- Promote open-source AI model development for cost efficiency and innovation
    - Incentivize private-sector open-source AI contributions by offering R&D tax breaks for companies that release non-proprietary AI models.
    - Fund university-led open-source AI frameworks, enabling researchers to build upon existing open-source AI models while maintaining U.S. leadership in AI safety and ethics.

Thank you for considering our recommendations. We remain committed to fostering collaboration and innovation to ensure the United States continues to lead in artificial intelligence research and development. Should you require further information or wish to discuss these proposals in greater detail, please do not hesitate to contact us.

Respectfully,

Sarkis Daglian
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[redacted]
